DEPARTMENT:	Product	PROJECT:	SCORE Report	FROM:	SD
DATE:	2026-03-16	PROJECT #:	PERL-00013	DRAFT:	D3.6

I. Pearl SCORE Report™ – Operational Brief

A. Project Overview

Here you briefly describe what you want done in a nutshell.

1. Primary Task

a) This brief's primary focus is on the delivery of the SCORE Report™ slated for the summer of 2026, noting that a preliminary working version has been requested for early April.

b) Define, design, and develop the Pearl SCORE Report — an interactive, paid, in-app experience that provides home buyers with a comprehensive performance analysis of a specific home they are seriously considering.

c) The SCORE Report is the deepest layer of a four-stage consumer journey that progressively builds the buyer's understanding of home performance:

   i) ILS Hook Widget — On the listing page. Gets attention. Introduces the Pearl SCORE metric and connects it to five things buyers care about. Free and ungated.

   ii) Snapshot (Modal) — Hover page triggered from the Widget. Adds context to each of the five information modules. Free and ungated. The Snapshot is also the default view for any home in the Pearl Registry that is not currently listed for sale — respecting homeowner privacy while maintaining a public presence.

   iii) Profile Page — On Pearl's site or in the Pearl App. Publicly visible for any home that is currently listed for sale, conceived for when the buyer arrives via an ILS but may be used directly through the Pearl Registry. Adds explanation — educates the buyer on what the five modules mean, why they matter, and why they should care about performance for this specific home. Contains the call to action to purchase the SCORE Report. Free, ungated and therefore cannot use home images or data included in data licensing restrictions.

   iv) SCORE Report — In the Pearl App. The deepest layer. Adds home-specific detail, analysis, and actionable insight across all five modules. Paid (pricing TBD).

d) All four layers share a prominent and consistent information architecture built on five modules:

   i) SCORE

   ii) Claim Status

   iii) Operating Cost

   iv) Five Pillars — Safety, Comfort, Operations, Resilience, Energy

   v) Achievements.

e) Each layer builds on the one before it: what is introduced at the Widget level is contextualized in the Snapshot, explained in the Profile, and detailed in the SCORE Report. The buyer is being trained in this architecture from first contact, and the SCORE Report must be recognizable as the culmination of that progression — not a departure from it.

B. Objective

What do you need to accomplish with this project?

1. Framework

a) The SCORE Report cannot be designed as a standalone artifact. It must be recognizable as the deepest layer of the consumer journey defined in Section B, built on the same five-module information architecture (SCORE, Claim Status, Operating Cost, Five Pillars, Achievements) that the buyer has encountered in the Widget, Snapshot, and Profile. The report expands and deepens what the buyer already knows — it does not introduce a new framework or obscure the existing one.

2. Audience-Specific

a) Create an interactive, in-app SCORE Report experience that accomplishes the following:

b) For the buyer

i) The SCORE Report must make home performance visible, understandable, and personally relevant for a specific home they are seriously considering. It must satisfy three core needs: the ability to compare this home's performance against similar homes, the ability to understand how the home's systems work and interact, and the ability to predict what living in this home will actually be like — operating costs, comfort, maintenance trajectory, and risk. The report must read as a specific analysis of a specific home, not a generic home performance primer. Even when data is limited, the content must orient the buyer to this home's particular performance story.

c) For the transaction

i) The SCORE Report must reduce friction by surfacing performance information early — before the inspection, before positions harden, before surprises can derail momentum. It should function as neutral, shared ground truth that both parties can reference, keeping performance conversations structured and proportional rather than adversarial or speculative. It must complement the inspection process, not compete with it or duplicate it.

d) For Pearl

i) The SCORE Report must serve as the company's primary consumer-facing data acquisition mechanism. Every interaction within the report experience should be designed to acquire verified, first-hand home performance data — whether from the buyer identifying gaps and routing structured questions to the seller, or from the seller proactively completing their home's performance profile. The report must strengthen the Pearl Registry with each use, building the proprietary dataset that is Pearl's competitive moat.

e) For agents

i) The SCORE Report must make agents feel safer, not more exposed. It must not introduce new disclosure obligations, create asymmetric risk, increase negotiation drag, or generate client confusion that agents must defend. Agents should see the report as a tool that enhances their professional value — facilitating informed conversations, reducing late-stage surprises, and supporting cleaner closings. For buy-side agents it explains and contextualizes the performance information available for a home. For the sell-side agent it provides agency over the home's marketing narrative.

C. Success Criteria

How will you know if you accomplished it? How will the quality of the outcome be measured?

1. Stakeholder Requirements

a) As a Product-Led Growth (PLG) company, Pearl's products are the primary driver of customer acquisition, conversion, and expansion. Therefore, they must deliver clear value while being easy and intuitive to use on their own. Success criteria will be divided among the most relevant stakeholders. The measurement and reporting methods for these criteria will be decided on by product.

b) Buyer Value

- i) Home buyers confirm the report would be valuable to them during their home search and purchase process.
- ii) Home buyers confirm the report delivers enough perceived value to justify a paid purchase at the intended price point (pricing TBD).
- iii) Home buyers confirm the report told them something meaningful about the home that they could not find on Zillow or comparable listing platforms.

c) Agent Acceptance

- i) Real estate agents (mix of buy-side and sell-side) review a prototype and confirm they would use or recommend the report in a transaction.
- ii) Agents confirm the report does not read as an inspection, does not diagnose defects, and does not introduce language that could create disclosure obligations.

2. Pearl Requirements

a) As a Data-Led company, Pearl's products are the primary driver of customer data acquisition. Therefore, they must collect data on the home while being easy and intuitive to use on their own. The measurement and reporting methods for these criteria will be decided on by product.

b) Coordination with other elements

- i) The five-module information architecture (SCORE, Claim Status, Operating Cost, Five Pillars, Achievements) is clearly recognizable as the spine of the report and consistent with how these modules appear in the Widget, Snapshot, and Profile.
- ii) The report reads as a specific analysis of a specific home — not a generic educational document.

c) Data Integrity

- i) The report is consistent with the Duck positioning.
- ii) A blanket statement in the Claim Status section indicating major data sources for the report should make data confidence scores or any other mechanisms to assess individual data integrity in the report unnecessary.

d) Data Acquisition

- i) Every major section of the report is designed to either present data or prompt its collection.
- ii) Only the home owner can add data to the home's account that will be reflected in the score. Information collected by buyers (e.g. inspection reports) may be retained for other use. Contingencies should be developed for this purpose.
- iii) The report experience includes at least one clear, structured mechanism for the buyer to surface questions and/or request information to their agent who can forward them to the sell-side agent.
- iv) The seller must be able to effortlessly add data on their home whether proactively at the time of listing or reactively when prompted by a buyer.

e) Legal and Positioning
   i) Legal review confirms the report's language does not create unreasonable liability exposure.
   ii) The report is clearly positioned as a performance guide, not a home inspection. This distinction is explicit in the report's introductory language and maintained throughout.

D. Deliverables

List the specific deliverables you expect from this project.

1. SCORE Report Experience (V1)

a) App Experience
   i) A fully functional, interactive, in-app experience accessible to buyers who purchase access to a specific home's SCORE Report. Content is home-specific, organized around the five-module information architecture, and satisfies the Compare, Understand, and Predict needs defined in Section D.
   ii) The experience must be viable for all use cases whether they access us through the registry or via an ILS:

b) Prototype for Testing
   i) A testable prototype sufficient to conduct the buyer and agent validation outlined in Section E (minimum 10 buyers, 6 agents). Does not need to be fully engineered — needs to be realistic enough that feedback is meaningful.

2. SCORE Report Content Framework (Appendix G)

a) The underlying content logic that drives what appears in the report: text segments, conditional display rules, and the decision logic that determines what content is shown based on available data for a given home. This framework must be documented and repeatable — not bespoke copywriting per home.

3. Consumer Journey Layer Definitions (Appendix C)

a) A clear definition of what each upstream layer (Widget, Snapshot, Profile) presents across the five modules and how each module deepens from layer to layer. This is a prerequisite for the SCORE Report and must be completed before report design is finalized.

4. SCORE Report Anatomy Definition (Appendix D)

a) A written definition of the report's internal architecture: the Core Report, the Priority Intake, and the three Addenda (Priority Alignment, Action Tools, Inspection Analysis). Includes the Worksheet concept and architectural requirements V1 must preserve.

5. Seller-Initiated SCORE Report Use Case (Appendix E)

a) Documentation of the seller flywheel dynamic: how sellers can proactively claim, complete, and author a SCORE Report as part of listing preparation, and how this behavior drives data acquisition and market normalization.

E. Activities/Phases

List the activities required to arrive at each of the deliverables.

1. Framework

a) This project is divided into two phases aligned with Pearl's release timeline. Phase 1 delivers a functional SCORE Report for the April launch. Phase 2 completes the full product vision for the summer release. Both phases are governed by the same brief — Phase 2 is not a separate project but the completion of what Phase 1 begins.

2. Phases

a) Phase 1: April Launch — Foundation
   i) The objective of Phase 1 is to deliver a credible, home-specific SCORE Report experience that demonstrates the product concept, establishes the information architecture, and can be used for early testing and partner conversations — even in the absence of live ILS or brokerage distribution.
   ii) Complete the Consumer Journey Layer Definitions (Appendix C) — define what each upstream layer presents across the five modules so the SCORE Report is designed as the culmination of a coherent sequence.
   iii) Define the SCORE Report structure and information architecture — confirm the five modules as the spine, define sections within each module, and establish the flow and logic of the experience.
   iv) Develop the content framework — text segments, conditional display logic, and rules that determine what content appears based on available data.
   v) Produce the V1 SCORE Report experience — interactive, in-app, for listed homes.
   vi) Conduct prototype testing per success criteria — minimum 10 prospective buyers and 6 agents.
   vii) Complete legal review of report language, positioning, and disclaimers.

b) Phase 2: Summer Release — Completion
   i) The objective of Phase 2 is to deliver the complete SCORE Report experience as defined in this brief, incorporating the features and depth that the compressed Phase 1 timeline could not accommodate.
   ii) Implement the Priority Intake and Addendum A (Priority Alignment) — AI-generated personalized interpretation of the Core Report.
   iii) Build personalized Action Tools (Addendum B) — questions for seller and inspector checklist tailored to buyer priorities.
   iv) Build the Inspection Report Analysis (Addendum C) — post-inspection interpretation mapped to five pillars and buyer priorities.
   v) Build the seller-initiated SCORE Report path — enabling homeowners to claim, complete, and author a report as part of listing preparation.
   vi) Add PDF download capability.
   vii) Deepen the content framework — expand conditional content to cover the full range of home features, systems, and scenarios.
   viii) Refine based on Phase 1 testing — incorporate buyer, agent, and internal feedback.

F. Timing

Broad-stroke overview of critical deadlines.

1. Context

a) No detailed Gantt or time plan exists for this project at the time of this brief. The product team is responsible for producing a working timeline for each phase that meets the process requirements established in Section G — including realistic deadlines, defined milestones, and structured review points with sponsors.

b) One timing dependency worth noting: Phase 1 ships before Pearl has secured live distribution on an ILS or brokerage platform. This means the April release will be evaluated primarily through prototype testing and partner-driven usage, not pure transaction usage. Phase 2

timing should account for the possibility that an ILS or brokerage partnership may be in progress by summer, which would change the stakes and scrutiny on the product considerably.

2. **Phase 1 release date:**
   a) Currently: April 2, 2026.
   b) Promotion concerning the release will be timed after this date due to the Easter holidays.
3. **Phase 2 release date:**
   a) Target summer 2026 (specific date TBD — to be confirmed by the product team as part of the Phase 1 closeout process).

G. Risk Mitigation

What factors pose the greatest risk of failure? How have they been addressed?

1. RISK: The SCORE Report is designed in isolation from the upstream consumer journey.
   a) The Widget, Snapshot, and Profile layers have not been fully defined. If the SCORE Report is built without resolving what comes before it, the five-module architecture will be inconsistent across layers, the buyer's experience will feel disjointed, and the report will fail to feel like the natural culmination of a progressive journey.
   b) Mitigation: Appendix C (Consumer Journey Layer Definitions) is a required deliverable that must be completed before SCORE Report design is finalized. The report cannot be approved without demonstrating architectural consistency with the upstream layers.
2. RISK: The report is perceived as an inspection or used as a negotiation weapon.
   a) If agents or sellers perceive the SCORE Report as diagnosing defects, creating disclosure obligations, or giving buyers ammunition for price reduction, adoption will stall.
   b) Mitigation: The report must be explicitly positioned as a performance guide, not an inspection. Language must describe characteristics and context, not diagnose conditions or assign fault. Legal review must confirm this positioning holds.
3. RISK: The report fails to acquire data for Pearl's registry.
   a) If the SCORE Report is designed purely as an output, Pearl misses its primary data acquisition opportunity. The report becomes a cost center rather than a flywheel.
   b) Mitigation: Every section of the report must be evaluated against the question: does this prompt or enable the collection of verified data? Even in Phase 1, the report must include at least one structured mechanism for buyers to surface questions and request information from sellers.
4. RISK: Legacy development habits undermine quality and timeline.
   a) The January 2026 MVP Brief identified legacy mindset as the biggest risk to Pearl's product development.
   b) Mitigation: Leadership will revisit Pearl's production process and provide additional clarity and support moving forward.
5. RISK: The April timeline produces a suboptimal product that damages perception.
   a) An eight-week build cycle, compressed from an originally planned six-month timeline, creates significant risk that the Phase 1 release will be incomplete or unpolished.
   b) Mitigation: Phase 1 must be explicitly framed as a foundation release. The Phase 1/Phase 2 scope split (Appendix F) must be documented and communicated so that what ships in April is understood as the first stage of a defined plan.
6. RISK: Bunny positioning creeps into the report's language.

a) The natural instinct when data is imperfect is to hedge, caveat, and apologize. If the report leads with caveats, it trains the reader to distrust the product before they experience value.
b) Mitigation: All report copy must be reviewed against the Duck positioning standard. Gaps are framed as opportunities, not deficits. Emphasize that Pearl is working with MLS data that the listing agent published as the home's official market representation.

H. Team/Reporting

Who the players are and what their responsibilities are.

1. **Responsible — who's actually doing the work**
   a) SCORE Report experience design and build: Jakob
   b) Content framework and conditional logic: Jakob
   c) Consumer Journey Layer Definitions (Appendix C): Sean
   d) Prototype for buyer/agent testing: Jakob
2. **Accountable — who owns the outcome and has final sign-off**
   a) Strategic direction and brief compliance: Sean
   b) Product delivery and quality: Jakob
   c) Final approval before each phase ships: Cynthia
3. **Consulted — who needs to provide input**
   a) Legal review: Cynthia
   b) Data/engineering team (data availability and content logic feasibility): Mike
   c) Agent advisory input (for prototype validation): Tim
4. **Informed — who just needs to be kept in the loop**
   a) Board/investor: Sandy/CDC
5. **Reporting Procedures**
   a) Per the process requirements established in Section G and the January 2026 MVP Brief, the following reporting procedures apply:
      i) Structured review dates must be defined at project kickoff and placed on all reviewers' calendars in advance. Reviews are not ad hoc events.
      ii) Review materials must be distributed to reviewers a minimum of 72 hours (3 business days) before the scheduled review date.
      iii) The project timeline must allocate working time after each review for the product team to discuss feedback with reviewers, agree on changes, and implement revisions before advancing to the next phase.
      iv) Each phase gate requires formal sign-off from the Accountable party before the next phase begins.

I. Guidelines or Suggestions

Any mandatories, tips, or requests?

1. Content must be accessible.
   a) The report should target a 6th-grade comprehension level. This applies to both copy and design.
      i) Language must be plain, narrative-driven, and free of jargon. The goal is comprehension and confidence, not technical depth.

ii) Design must reduce cognitive load, appear intuitive to navigate, and appeal to the attention span of a 6th grader.

2. Comparable Home Profile governs all comparisons.
   a) All comparisons in the report — at the overall SCORE level, at Operating Cost, and at each pillar — must be made against a defined peer group: homes of similar vintage, built under similar building codes, of similar size and geometry, in the same climate zone and market area. This peer group is called the Comparable Home Profile. A 1965 home is compared to other 1960s-era homes in a similar climate, not to new construction or to the national average. This must be applied consistently throughout the report.
3. Scoring granularity policy.
   a) The overall SCORE is presented as a number (0–1000).
   b) The five pillars are presented with qualitative ratings (e.g., Good, Typical, Below Typical) and narrative context, supported by visual indicators, but without numerical sub-scores, point allocations, or weighting disclosure.
   c) Pearl does not sub-score individual features, systems, or components. Within each pillar, the report describes what was found and what it means in narrative form, not in point form. This is consistent with how established rating authorities (FICO, ENERGY STAR) operate: they provide authoritative conclusions with directional context, not granular point mechanics. This policy protects Pearl's credibility, avoids cognitive overload, and prevents the report from becoming a forum for disputes over individual feature valuations.
4. Exclusions — what the SCORE Report must NOT include.
   a) Recommendations for upgrades or improvements (this is a separate product — the Improvement Plan)
   b) Performance-based property valuation or price implications (Pearl is not an appraiser; an appraisal addendum exists for certification but is out of scope for the buyer-stage SCORE Report)
   c) Diagnosis of defects or condition assessment
   d) Contractor recommendations or referrals
   e) Cost estimates for repairs or improvements
   f) Comparisons to specific neighboring properties by address
   g) Any content that positions Pearl as rendering a professional opinion on habitability, safety compliance, or code compliance
   h) Numerical sub-scores for individual features, systems, or components
   i) Disclosure of point allocation or weighting methodology
5. Respect the Carfax analogy — but know its limits.
   a) The Carfax model is a powerful strategic reference. But unlike Carfax, Pearl is dealing with a latent need — buyers aren't searching for performance information yet. And unlike a used car transaction, a home sale involves a living seller who can actively participate. The SCORE Report must account for both: it must create awareness, not just satisfy it, and it must facilitate a two-way exchange, not just deliver a one-way report.

J. Attachments

Any documents attached related to this assignment.

1. Pearl 2.0 MVP Brief, D1.3 (January 8, 2026, SD) — The north star product vision brief covering segmentation, needs analysis, buyer journey, target persona, and success criteria.

2. Framing Insight: My Carfax Moment (January 7, 2026, NT/CA) — Establishes the Carfax analogy, transaction moments, distribution strategy, and agent safety constraints.
3. Pearl App Value Proposition (January 8, 2026, NT/SD) — Comprehensive value proposition covering buyer/seller/agent needs, the "on rails" framework, and "value before verification" principle.
4. Pearl Positioning Brief: Duck Position (February 11, 2026, SD) — Internal positioning document governing how Pearl talks about data, value, and the home performance gap. Mandatory for all SCORE Report copy.
5. AI & Monetization Memo (February 11, 2026, SD) — Establishes dual-purpose design (value + data acquisition), the "tokens in = data" framework, and staged monetization roadmap.
6. SCORE Report D1.0 Draft (February 10, 2026, CD/JB) — Current first draft with layouts and copy. To be evaluated against this brief.
7. SCORE Report PRD (January 15, 2026, CD/RL) — Jakob's SCORE Report production spec.
8. SCORE Report PRD (January 23, 2026, CD/RL) — Robin's content production spec.
9. **Appendix HTML Visualizations**
   a) ILS Hook Widget Anatomy
   b) Snapshot Anatomy
   c) Profile Page Anatomy
   d) SCORE Report Anatomy
   e) Production Phases
   f) SCORE Report Flywheel
   g) SCORE Report Outline

K. Background

How did we get here in a nutshell?

1. Pearl is building the nation's first standardized home performance database — the Pearl Home Performance Registry — with the goal of making home performance a standard consideration in every real estate transaction in America. The company's strategic product roadmap identifies four consumer-facing information layers that progressively deepen a buyer's engagement with home performance: the ILS Hook Widget, the Snapshot, the Profile Page, and the SCORE Report. Each layer builds on the last, maintaining a consistent information architecture across five modules: SCORE, Claim Status, Operating Cost, Five Pillars, and Achievements.
2. The SCORE Report sits at the deepest layer of this sequence. It is the first paid consumer product and the first point of monetization in the buyer journey. It is also Pearl's primary mechanism for acquiring verified, first-hand home performance data from transaction participants — making it simultaneously a consumer product and a data acquisition tool.
3. A thorough PRD and first draft of the SCORE Report (D1.0) has been produced — layouts completed in Figma, copy written. This brief establishes the strategic framework that the current draft can be evaluated and refined against to clarify strategic objectives, target needs, success criteria, or structural requirements.
4. **Previous Decisions**
   a) There's been a lot of discussion about the SCORE report over the last year. A few things that are important to bear in mind as development commences:
5. Secondary access path — Seller-initiated SCORE Report
   a) Homeowners who intend to sell can also access the SCORE Report for their own home prior to listing. By claiming their home and proactively completing their performance profile through the Worksheet, sellers can produce a comprehensive, seller-authored SCORE Report to include in their listing package — offered free to prospective buyers. This creates a competitive advantage for the seller (controlling the performance narrative and demonstrating transparency) and a powerful data acquisition flywheel for Pearl (sellers voluntarily providing verified data to strengthen their own report). As this behavior normalizes, homes without a completed SCORE Report will stand out negatively — just as homes without a Carfax report do in the used car market — creating market pressure that drives claiming and data contribution at scale. (See Appendix E for a full treatment of this use case.)
6. Data foundation for listed homes
   a) Because the SCORE Report is only available for homes currently listed for sale, Pearl has access to MLS listing data — information the listing agent has published as part of the home's official market representation. The SCORE Report builds on this foundation, supplemented by public records, modeled estimates, and any homeowner-verified data if the home has been claimed. Pearl does not need to apologize for gaps in this data; the MLS listing represents what the seller's agent chose to put on the record. Where information is incomplete, the report should frame that transparently as an opportunity for the seller to provide more — not as a Pearl shortcoming.
7. Critical prerequisite
   a) The specific content, depth, and objective of each upstream layer (Widget, Snapshot, Profile) have not yet been fully defined. Because the SCORE Report must fit coherently into this sequence, this brief includes an appendix (Appendix C: Consumer Journey Layer Definitions) that defines what each layer must accomplish, what information it presents, and how each

module evolves from layer to layer. The SCORE Report cannot be properly designed until this upstream architecture is resolved.

b) The SCORE Report must satisfy three core buyer needs — Compare, Understand, and Predict — across all general buyer segments (first-time and repeat). It must deliver more actionable insight than buyers can find on any existing listing platform and be useful both before and after the home inspection. Every element of the experience must serve a dual purpose: delivering genuine value to the buyer while acquiring verified home performance data that strengthens Pearl's registry.

c) At launch in April, the SCORE Report will be an online experience within the Pearl App; PDF download will follow in a subsequent release.

d) A future evolution of the SCORE Report — the SCORE Worksheet — has been identified as a strategic opportunity. The Worksheet concept envisions the report area as an interactive platform where buyers surface their priorities, generate structured questions to the seller or listing agent "on rails," and collaboratively work toward clarity on performance topics — with the finalized report as the output of that process. This concept is defined in Appendix D so that the V1 architecture does not preclude it, even if full Worksheet functionality is deferred beyond the initial launch.

8. Prototyping does not preclude planning.

a) This has been a Pearl 1.0 issue. The rapid prototyping approach adopted by the product team is accepted as a development methodology. However, prototyping defers strategic evaluation into the review cycle — it does not eliminate it. When the team chooses to build before planning, the review phase becomes the planning phase, and it must be given the time, rigor, and authority that planning demands. Reviewers must be prepared to require significant changes, and the team must be prepared to implement them — including structural rework if the prototype does not meet the standard defined in this brief. That is the implicit contract of building before planning: you accept the risk that the output may need to be substantially revised or rebuilt once scrutiny is applied. That requires building time into the schedule.

9. The SCORE Report must read as home-specific, not generic.

a) Every section of the report must be grounded in the specific home's data, characteristics, vintage, systems, climate zone, and context. The test is simple: if you could swap in a different address and the report reads the same, it has failed.

10. Duck positioning governs all copy.

a) All report language must follow the Duck positioning standard established in the Pearl Positioning Brief (February 2026). Never apologize for the data. Lead with value, not caveats. Frame gaps as opportunity, not deficit. For listed homes, the SCORE Report is built on MLS data that the listing agent published as the home's official market representation.

11. The five-module architecture is the spine.

a) The five information modules — SCORE, Claim Status, Operating Cost, Five Pillars (Safety, Comfort, Operations, Resilience, Energy), and Achievements — must be clearly recognizable as the organizing structure of the report. If a reader who has seen the Snapshot cannot immediately recognize the same architecture in the SCORE Report, the structure has failed.

12. Every section must serve data acquisition.

a) No section of the report should be purely decorative or one-directional. The question to ask of every element: does this prompt or enable the buyer, seller, or agent to contribute information that improves this home's record in the Pearl Registry?

13. The report is not an inspection.

a) This distinction must be explicit in the report's introductory language and maintained throughout. The SCORE Report describes performance characteristics and context. It does not diagnose defects, assess condition, or assign fault. It complements the inspection process by giving buyers a performance framework before the inspection occurs.

14. Process Requirements

a) The Pearl 2.0 MVP Brief (January 2026) established process requirements. Leadership will review this process with Product to ascertain practicality and where improvements could be made:
   i) A development process must be created against a timeline with realistic deadlines.
   ii) Roles, responsibilities, and approval procedures must be clearly defined.
   iii) Proper quality assurance and pre-launch testing must be included in the timeline.
   iv) There must be regular, structured presentations to sponsors to demonstrate progress and elicit feedback (not ad hoc Slack messages requiring immediate turnaround).
   v) The project should be divided into phases with clear completion and approval criteria, where each phase is approved before the next begins.

b) These specifications were identified in the January brief as direct mitigations of legacy mindset risks — specifically, ambiguous timelines, failure to anticipate risks, lack of quality assurance, and uncoordinated product initiatives. The board has stated its expectation of a clear and noticeable shift from Pearl 1.0 development habits.

c) (See Appendix F: Phase 1 vs. Phase 2 Scope for a detailed mapping of each deliverable to its target phase.)

L. How it is Today

Define the situation as it is today — specifically, the problem you are trying to solve.

1. Today, a home buyer comparing properties online can access listing photos, price history, square footage, neighborhood data, school ratings, and estimated mortgage payments — but has no structured way to understand how any of those homes actually perform. Performance — the safety, comfort, operating cost, resilience, and energy characteristics that determine what it's actually like to live in a home — is invisible at every stage of the buyer's journey until it surfaces, often as a surprise, during inspection or after purchase.
2. This isn't because the information is being hidden. Sellers themselves typically don't understand their own home's performance profile and have no framework for communicating it. Buyers don't know what questions to ask. Agents on both sides lack the vocabulary and tools to facilitate performance conversations without introducing friction, liability risk, or negotiation drag. The result is that two non-experts are forced to navigate expert-level topics under high stakes, time pressure, and misaligned incentives — and the conversation itself becomes the risk.
3. The consequences are material. Deals collapse post-offer when performance issues surface at inspection — in some markets, more than one in five sales fall apart after the offer is made. Even when deals close, buyers frequently encounter unexpected operating costs, maintenance surprises, and comfort issues that erode confidence and satisfaction. Late-stage discovery doesn't just hurt buyers; it damages sellers through price erosion, renegotiation, and deal failure, and it frustrates agents who lose time and commission on transactions that should have closed cleanly.
4. No product on the market today addresses this problem comprehensively. Home inspections are diagnostic but occur after commitment, cover condition rather than performance, and produce reports designed for professionals, not consumers. Energy audits address only one dimension. Listing platforms provide no performance layer. But the deeper challenge is that most buyers are not actively seeking performance information in the first place. Home performance is a latent need — buyers don't think about safety, comfort, operating costs, resilience, or energy characteristics until something forces the issue, typically when the inspection report lands and performance problems are suddenly real, urgent, and expensive. The need exists, but awareness does not. Pearl must create that awareness early in the journey — making performance matter to buyers before commitment and pressure peak — and then provide the structured tools to act on it.

M. Consumer Journey Layer Definitions

Defines what each upstream layer (Widget, Snapshot, Profile) presents across the five modules and how each module deepens from layer to layer.

1. Governing Principles

a) The Pearl consumer journey is a four-layer progressive disclosure system. Each layer has one job. The content at each layer must earn the next click by doing that job well — not by trying to accomplish everything at once. The five information modules (SCORE, Claim Status, Operating Cost, Five Pillars, Achievements) are present at every layer and form the consistent architecture the buyer is trained on from first contact.

2. Data Availability Constraint

a) The architecture must work credibly at every data level. There are three tiers:
   i) Tier 1 — Baseline (always available). Pearl will always have five foundational data points: (1) square footage, (2) year built, (3) climate zone, (4) geometry/footprint, and (5) applicable building code based on location and year of construction. From these five, Pearl can model the home as originally built. This data is public and non-proprietary.
   ii) Tier 2 — Purchased/proprietary (available for some homes). Permit history, assessor records, and other data Pearl buys market by market. Commercially sensitive; reserved for the paid SCORE Report behind the paywall.
   iii) Tier 3 — Claimed/verified (when the seller engages). First-hand information contributed by the homeowner. The most accurate and valuable data tier. Transforms the SCORE from a model into a verified record.

b) The consumer journey layers align with these data tiers: free layers use free data, the paid layer uses data Pearl pays for, and claimed data enriches everything.

3. Layer 1: ILS Hook Widget

a) Where: On the listing page (Zillow, Redfin, etc.) or in the Pearl Registry.

b) Access: Free, ungated. Data tier: Tier 1 only.

c) Buyer's mindset: Browsing. Scanning dozens of listings. Does not know what home performance is.

d) The Widget's one job: Interrupt the scroll — introduce a new metric and immediately connect it to five things the buyer already cares about.

e) What each module shows:
   i) SCORE: The Pearl SCORE number displayed prominently. No methodology, no explanation. Just the number.
   ii) Claim Status: Not shown at this layer.
   iii) Operating Cost: Not shown at this layer.
   iv) Five Pillars: Shown as a visual element — the five pillar names presented to signal that performance is multidimensional. No pillar scores.
   v) Achievements: Not shown at this layer.

f) Action prompted: Click to open the Snapshot.

4. Layer 2: Snapshot (Modal)

a) Where: Hover page/modal triggered from Widget. Also the default view for unlisted homes in the Pearl Registry.

b) Access: Free, ungated. Data tier: Tier 1 only.

c) Buyer's mindset: Curious. Has given Pearl maybe 30 seconds. Asking: "What is this? Is this relevant to me?"

d) The Snapshot's one job: Provide enough context so the buyer understands what Pearl measures and why it might matter — connecting performance to things they already care about: money, comfort, safety.
e) What each module shows:
   i) SCORE: The SCORE number with brief contextual statement — where this home sits on the scale, contextualized against homes of similar vintage and location (Comparable Home Profile). One to two sentences.
   ii) Claim Status: Introduced here. Simple indicator (claimed/unclaimed) with brief explanation. Framed neutrally.
   iii) Operating Cost: Introduced here. Estimated monthly cost with brief comparative statement against the Comparable Home Profile.
   iv) Five Pillars: Each pillar shown with its qualitative rating (Good, Typical, Below Typical) and a one-line description. No numerical sub-scores.
   v) Achievements: Shown if applicable with brief labels.
f) Action prompted: Click through to the Profile Page.

5. **Layer 3: Profile Page**
   a) Where: On Pearl's website or in the Pearl App. Publicly visible for listed homes. Same page regardless of entry point.
   b) Access: Free, ungated. Data tier: Tier 1, presented with greater specificity.
   c) Buyer's mindset: Interested. On Pearl's turf. Willing to spend a few minutes. Asking: "Is this worth paying for?"
   d) The Profile's one job: Educate the buyer on what the five modules mean and begin to make it personal for this home — so the buyer concludes they need the full SCORE Report.
   e) The Profile draws heavily on baseline data to make the experience feel home-specific — referencing year of construction, climate zone, what the applicable building code means for original performance standards. It does not expose Tier 2 purchased/proprietary data.
   f) What each module shows:
      i) SCORE: Expanded explanation of what the SCORE represents and what it means for this home's type, age, and location.
      ii) Claim Status: Expanded explanation of claimed vs. unclaimed and what it means for the buyer. Pathway to request claiming.
      iii) Operating Cost: More context on what drives costs for a home of this type, compared against the Comparable Home Profile.
      iv) Five Pillars: Short narrative per pillar explaining what it measures, why it matters, and how this home relates to its vintage and location.
      v) Achievements: Explained in context. If none, brief explanation of what achievements are.
   g) Action prompted: Purchase the SCORE Report.

6. **Layer 4: SCORE Report**
   a) Where: In the Pearl App.
   b) Access: Paid (pricing TBD). Data tier: All available tiers.
   c) Buyer's mindset: Serious. This home is on their short list. Willing to spend time and money to understand it.
   d) The SCORE Report's one job: Deliver a comprehensive, home-specific performance analysis across all five modules with enough depth to satisfy Compare, Understand, and Predict for this particular home.
   e) See Appendix D for the full internal anatomy of the SCORE Report experience.

7. Summary Table: Module Evolution Across Layers

Module	Widget	Snapshot	Profile	SCORE Report
SCORE	Number + heading	Number + vintage context	Expanded narrative	Full analysis + drivers
Claim Status	Not shown	Simple indicator	Expanded + request path	Full transparency + prompts
Operating Cost	Not shown	Monthly estimate + comparison	Drivers + variability	Detailed breakdown
Five Pillars	Names only (visual)	Qualitative ratings + one-liners	Short narrative per pillar	Full section per pillar
Achievements	Not shown	Labels if applicable	Explained in context	Full presentation
Data Tier	Tier 1	Tier 1	Tier 1 (specific)	Tiers 1 + 2 + 3
Access	Free, ungated	Free, ungated	Free, ungated	Paid
One Job	Interrupt	Make relevant	Educate + convert	Deliver analysis

N. SCORE Report Anatomy

Defines the report's internal architecture: the Core Report, the Priority Intake, and the three Addenda.

1. Overview

a) The SCORE Report is not a static document. It is an interactive, in-app experience built on a simple structural principle: one objective Core Report per home, consistent for every buyer, supplemented by personalized addenda that interpret the report through the individual buyer's lens.

b) The Core Report is Pearl's authoritative analysis. It does not change based on who is reading it. The addenda are where personalization, action tools, and post-inspection analysis live — clearly labeled as buyer-specific. This separation preserves the Core Report's credibility and comparability, reduces computational complexity, and scales cleanly for buyers comparing multiple homes.

2. Section 1: Priority Intake — "What matters most to you?"

a) A short, structured intake that asks the buyer to identify which performance dimensions matter most and optionally flag specific concerns. Happens immediately after purchase, as the first step of the SCORE Report experience — before the buyer sees any report content.

b) Why it happens after purchase, not before or during

i) Placing the priority intake in the purchase flow creates friction at the moment of highest drop-off risk. Placing it after purchase accomplishes three things:

ii) It signals premium personalization. Being asked "What matters most to you?" as the first interaction communicates that this is a tailored experience.

iii) It eliminates purchase friction. The transaction completes cleanly.

iv) It acquires data at the optimal moment. The buyer is most engaged right after paying.

c) If the buyer skips the intake, the Core Report is unaffected. Addenda are either omitted or generated with equal weight across all pillars.

3. Section 2: Core Report — The Five-Module Spine

a) The objective, home-specific performance analysis. Identical for every buyer viewing this home. Does not change based on buyer priorities or addenda. Its authority comes from its objectivity.

b) All comparisons within the Core Report are made against the Comparable Home Profile: homes of similar vintage, building code, size, geometry, and climate zone/location.

c) The five modules:

i) Module 1 — SCORE. The overall Pearl SCORE (0–1000). What's driving it, how it compares to the Comparable Home Profile, what it means in practical terms. Narrative must be specific to this home.

ii) Module 2 — Claim Status. Full transparency on data sources and confidence levels. What is modeled, what comes from purchased records, what has been verified. Gaps framed as opportunity. Pathways for the buyer to request more information through their agent.

iii) Module 3 — Operating Cost. Estimated monthly operating cost, breakdown by category, comparison to the Comparable Home Profile, drivers of cost, and context for variability. Framed as estimate, not guarantee.

iv) Module 4 — Five Pillars (Safety, Comfort, Operations, Resilience, Energy). Each pillar gets a dedicated section with: qualitative rating (Good, Typical, Below Typical), summary of how this home performs relative to the Comparable Home Profile, what was found, why it matters for daily life, and what to explore further. No numerical sub-scores. No point allocations.

v) Module 5 — Achievements. Certifications, badges, or milestones with full explanation. Absence framed as future opportunity, not deficit.

4. **Section 3: Addendum A — Priority Alignment**
   a) "How this home lines up with what matters to you."
   b) An AI-generated interpretation that reads the Core Report through the buyer's priority lens. Highlights where the home is strong, typical, or worth investigating relative to what this buyer cares about. Does not alter the Core Report. If the buyer skipped priority intake, this addendum is not generated.
   c) For buyers comparing multiple homes: each home gets the same-format Core Report (directly comparable) plus a Priority Alignment addendum showing how that specific home maps to their priorities.
5. **Section 4: Addendum B — Action Tools**
   a) "What to ask and what to look for."
   b) Questions for the Seller/Listing Agent: Structured, pre-written questions generated from data gaps and buyer priorities. On rails — the buyer doesn't have to invent the right words. Professional, neutral, shareable with buyer's agent.
   c) Inspector Checklist: Tailored checklist of performance-relevant items for the inspector to confirm. Focuses attention on what matters for this home. Complements the inspection, doesn't compete with it.
6. **Section 5: Addendum C — Inspection Report Analysis**
   a) "What your inspection report means for this home's performance."
   b) Buyer uploads their inspection report. Pearl interprets findings through the five pillars and buyer priorities. Plain-language translation of technical results. Does not change the Core Report or the home's official record. Every uploaded report enriches Pearl's data on the property.
7. **What Is Fixed vs. What Varies**
   a) Governing rule: Pearl produces one Core Report per home. It is the same for every buyer. Only the homeowner can change the home's official record. The addenda are personalized per buyer. The underlying facts never change; only the interpretation and action tools vary.
8. Phasing

Report Element	Fixed or Variable	Who Controls It
Core Report (five modules)	Fixed per home	Pearl (based on available data)
Addendum A: Priority Alignment	Variable per buyer	Generated from Core Report + priorities
Addendum B: Action Tools	Variable per buyer	Generated from data gaps + priorities
Addendum C: Inspection Analysis	Variable per buyer	Generated from uploaded report
Home's official record	Fixed	Homeowner only

Section	Phase 1 (April)	Phase 2 (Summer)
Priority Intake	Include if feasible	Full implementation
Core Report	Full implementation	Deepened content framework
Addendum A: Priority Alignment	Not included	Full implementation (AI)
Addendum B: Action Tools	Basic (standard questions)	Personalized to buyer priorities
Addendum C: Inspection Analysis	Not included	Full implementation (AI)

O. Seller-Initiated SCORE Report — Flywheel Dynamic

Documents the seller flywheel dynamic: how sellers can proactively claim, complete, and author a SCORE Report as part of listing preparation.

1. Overview: Two Paths to a SCORE Report

a) There are two scenarios under which a SCORE Report is generated for a home. They produce very different outcomes for the buyer, the seller, and Pearl.

b) Scenario 1 — Buyer-initiated (unclaimed home). This is the scenario that has received the most attention internally. The home is listed but unclaimed. The buyer purchases a SCORE Report on their own. The report is generated from whatever data Pearl has: baseline modeling, MLS listing data, and any purchased records. The seller has had no input. The report is competent but limited by available data. The buyer pays for this report themselves.

c) Scenario 2 — Seller-initiated (claimed home). This is the scenario that has been less discussed but represents the greater strategic opportunity. Before listing, the seller proactively claims their home and completes their performance profile. The seller then purchases a listing package that includes the completed SCORE Report, which buyers can access for free as part of the listing. The report is built on verified, first-hand data — substantially richer and more confident. The seller controls the narrative. The buyer gets a better product at no cost. Pearl gets the verified data that builds its registry.

d) Both scenarios use the same SCORE Report architecture (see Appendix B). The difference is the quality of the data underneath.

2. The Opportunity

a) Scenario 1 is where Pearl starts. Most homes will be unclaimed at launch. But Scenario 2 is where Pearl needs to get to — because it solves the data acquisition problem, improves the product for everyone, and creates the market dynamics that make Pearl indispensable.

3. How It Works

a) A homeowner who intends to sell claims their home on the Pearl Registry and begins completing their performance profile through the Worksheet. As they do, two things happen simultaneously: the home's SCORE becomes more accurate and confident, and a completed SCORE Report is generated that the seller can stand behind and include in their listing package.

4. The Seller's Incentive

a) Control the narrative. Without a seller-initiated report, the buyer purchases their own and forms conclusions based on incomplete data. By proactively completing the profile, the seller controls how the home's performance story is told.

b) Competitive advantage. In a market where some listings include a SCORE Report and others don't, the ones that do signal confidence, preparation, and transparency. The seller-initiated report reduces friction for the buyer, making the home easier to sell.

5. The Flywheel

a) Stage 1 — Early adoption. A small number of sellers proactively complete SCORE Reports. Their listings stand out.

b) Stage 2 — Buyer expectation begins to form. More buyers encounter seller-provided reports and begin to expect them. Buyers start asking agents: "Does this home have a SCORE Report?"

c) Stage 3 — Market pressure normalizes the behavior. The absence of a SCORE Report becomes notable — the same way the absence of a Carfax report is notable in the used car market.

d) Stage 4 — Data flywheel reaches critical mass. More sellers complete profiles. Richer data improves all reports. The product gets better, increasing buyer demand, increasing seller pressure, generating more data.

6. **What Pearl Gets**
   a) Every seller who completes their profile provides verified, first-hand data that cannot be obtained any other way. Each completed profile also improves Pearl's modeling for similar unclaimed homes — strengthening the entire registry.
7. **What Pearl Must Provide in Return**
   a) The seller must receive clear, immediate value: control over their home's public profile, a report they can stand behind, and the knowledge that more data means better accuracy and — in the future — potentially lower costs for Pearl's products and services.
8. Phasing: The seller-initiated path is a Phase 2 deliverable. Phase 1 must not preclude it — the architecture must support seller-contributed data from the start.

P. Phase 1 vs. Phase 2 Scope

Maps every deliverable and feature to either Phase 1 (April) or Phase 2 (summer).

1. **Purpose**
   a) This appendix maps every deliverable and feature to either Phase 1 (April) or Phase 2 (summer). Phase 1 is a foundation release, not the finished product. Phase 2 is not optional — it is the completion of the product defined in this brief.
2. Phase 1: April Launch — What Must Ship
3. Phase 1: What Is Explicitly Deferred
4. Phase 2: Summer Release — What Must Ship
5. **The Governing Expectation**
   a) Phase 1 ships a foundation. Phase 2 is not optional. The items deferred from Phase 1 were deferred because of timeline compression, not because they are less important. The product team must begin Phase 2 planning before Phase 1 ships, so that the summer release is driven by a timeline, not by whatever bandwidth remains after April.

Phase 1: April Launch — What Must Ship

Item	Description
Core Report (five modules)	Full implementation of the five-module spine
Comparable Home Profile	Vintage-adjusted comparisons at all levels
Qualitative pillar ratings	Good/Typical/Below Typical — no numerical sub-scores
Content framework (basic)	Conditional text for core home types and data scenarios
Journey Layer Definitions	Appendix C completed and documented
Action Tools (basic)	Standard questions and inspector checklist (not personalized)
Duck positioning	All copy reviewed against Duck standard
Legal review	Language, disclaimers, positioning confirmed
Prototype testing	Minimum 10 buyers, 6 agents validate

Phase 1: What Is Explicitly Deferred

Item	Reason for Deferral
Priority Intake	Include if feasible; Core Report does not depend on it
Addendum A: Priority Alignment	Requires Priority Intake + AI generation
Addendum B: Personalized Tools	Basic tools in Phase 1; personalization requires Intake
Addendum C: Inspection Analysis	Requires AI document analysis capability
SCORE Worksheet	Requires claiming workflow + on-rails exchange
Seller-initiated path	Requires Worksheet and listing package definition
PDF download	Online experience only at launch
Full content framework	Expanded content for all scenarios deferred

Phase 2: Summer Release — What Must Ship

Item	Description
Priority Intake	Full implementation as first step after purchase
Addendum A: Priority Alignment	AI-generated personalized interpretation
Addendum B: Personalized Tools	Questions + checklist tailored to buyer priorities
Addendum C: Inspection Analysis	Upload inspection report; Pearl interprets through five pillars
SCORE Worksheet	Interactive seller claiming and profile completion flow
Seller-initiated path	Claim, complete, generate report for listing package
PDF download	Downloadable Core Report
Expanded content framework	All home types, features, systems, climate zones
Phase 1 refinements	Incorporate testing feedback

Q. SCORE Report Outline — Proposed Section Flow

Describes the SCORE Report at full product maturity, including Phase 2 features. Phase 1 will ship a subset as defined in Appendix F.

1. **Onboarding: Priority Intake**
   a) "What matters most to you?" Happens after purchase, before the report loads. Not a section of the report — it's the entry experience that shapes the personalized addenda. Skippable, no penalty.
2. **Introduction**
   a) The buyer's first view inside the report. Orients them to the specific home and to the report itself.
      i) Home photo and address
      ii) Baseline home profile: year built, applicable building code, climate zone, geometry/type, square footage
      iii) Permit history (where available — Tier 2 data, behind paywall)
      iv) Brief orientation text: what this report is, what it isn't, how to use it
   b) This section grounds everything that follows in a specific home. The buyer should read this and think "yes, this is about my house" before they see a single score.
3. **Your Home at a Glance**
   a) An executive summary of the entire report in one visual display. The SCORE, claim status, operating cost estimate, all five pillar qualitative ratings, and achievements — represented together as a dashboard. Nothing here is new content; everything previews a section that follows in full detail below.
   b) Designed for two purposes: first, to orient the buyer before they dive into the detail; second, to serve as the comparison view. A buyer with three SCORE Reports lines up these three dashboards to get a quick, structured lay of the land across their short list.
4. **Section 1: SCORE**
   a) The overall Pearl SCORE (0–1000). What's driving it, how it compares to the Comparable Home Profile, what it means practically for living in this home.
5. **Section 2: Claim Status**
   a) Whether the home is claimed or unclaimed. What data the report is built on — baseline modeling, MLS listing data, purchased records, homeowner-verified information. What claiming would add. Pathway for the buyer to request claiming through their agent. Duck positioning throughout.
   b) Includes a general data transparency statement covering the entire report: a plainly written acknowledgment that for unclaimed homes, particularly older homes without permit records, there may be upgrades, replacements, or changes that are not reflected in the report because only the homeowner can provide that information. This statement covers the whole report — individual sections do not carry their own data quality qualifiers.
6. **Section 3: Operating Cost**
   a) Estimated monthly operating cost. Breakdown by category. Comparison to the Comparable Home Profile. What's driving costs for this home. Variability context. Framed as estimate, not guarantee.
7. **Section 4: Five Pillars**
   a) One dedicated sub-section per pillar — Safety, Comfort, Operations, Resilience, Energy. Each follows the same structure:

    i) Qualitative rating (Good, Typical, Below Typical)
    ii) Summary vs. Comparable Home Profile
    iii) What we found
    iv) Why it matters for daily life
    v) What to explore further
  b) No numerical sub-scores. No point allocations. No per-pillar confidence ratings. The general data transparency statement in Claim Status covers the entire report.

8. **Section 5: Achievements**
  a) Certifications, badges, or milestones with full explanation. Absence framed as future opportunity.

9. **Addendum A: Priority Alignment**
  a) "How this home lines up with what matters to you." AI-generated interpretation of the Core Report through the buyer's priority lens. Only generated if the buyer completed the Priority Intake.

10. **Addendum B: Action Tools**
  a) Questions for the Seller/Listing Agent — structured, on-rails, shareable.
  b) Inspector Checklist — tailored to this home's profile and buyer's priorities.

11. **Addendum C: Inspection Report Analysis**
  a) Post-inspection. Buyer uploads inspection report. Pearl interprets findings through the five pillars and buyer priorities.